

TUTORIAL

Single Crochet vs Double Crochet: What's the Difference?

Two of the most common crochet stitches, and how to tell which one a project actually needs.

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Single crochet (sc) and double crochet (dc) are the two stitches most patterns are built around, and beginners often learn them back to back without a clear sense of when to use which. This guide breaks down both, side by side.

How to work single crochet

Steps

1. Insert your hook into the next stitch.
2. Yarn over and pull up a loop (2 loops now on the hook).
3. Yarn over again and pull through both loops on the hook (1 loop remains — stitch complete).

How to work double crochet

Steps

1. Yarn over before inserting your hook — this extra wrap is what makes the stitch taller.
2. Insert your hook into the next stitch, yarn over, and pull up a loop (3 loops now on the hook).
3. Yarn over and pull through the first 2 loops only (2 loops remain).
4. Yarn over again and pull through the remaining 2 loops (1 loop remains — stitch complete).

Side-by-side comparison

- **Height:** double crochet stands roughly twice as tall as single crochet.
- **Density:** single crochet makes a dense, gap-free fabric; double crochet leaves small visible gaps between stitches.
- **Speed:** double crochet grows a project roughly twice as fast, row for row.
- **Best for:** single crochet suits amigurumi, dishcloths, and tight bags; double crochet suits blankets, garments, and quick makes.
- **Turning chain:** single crochet uses a chain 1 that doesn't count as a stitch; double crochet's chain 3 does count as the first stitch of the row.

Which should you learn first?

Most crocheters learn single crochet first, since its slower growth makes tension easier to control while you're still getting comfortable with the hook. Our [basic crochet stitches guide](#) and [easiest first projects](#) both start there before introducing double crochet.

Frequently asked questions

Is double crochet the same as UK treble crochet?

Yes — UK stitch names shift up one level from US terms (UK dc = US sc, UK tr = US dc), which is why "US terms" matters. See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full comparison.

Which stitch uses more yarn?

Double crochet grows faster per stitch, but single crochet fabric is denser, so total yarn used for a given finished size ends up fairly similar — density matters more than stitch height.

Can I mix single and double crochet in the same project?

Yes, this is common and gives texture — granny squares, for example, alternate double crochet groups with chain spaces.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.